

Name: _____ Date: _____

Adapted from the official New Close-up B1 Unit 3 Assessment (National Geographic Learning / Cengage, permission granted to photocopy for classroom use), trimmed to fit 40 minutes alongside the writing error-review. The writing task from the full 80-mark original is not included — Unit 3's writing (SB pp.38-39, the environment email) was written in class earlier this unit and marked separately. Two further exercises from the full test (a fossil-fuel vocabulary word bank and a grammar error-correction task) were also dropped to fit the time, since both are already well covered by this unit's own classwork.

Reading**/ 5**

Read the text about the effects of global warming.

Warmer Earth: BIGGER spiders

The Arctic is well-known for its ice and glaciers. The area also contains a variety of different ecosystems with complex food webs. You might think it is extremely difficult for any animal to stay alive in temperatures of up to -50°C in the winter months, but many do thanks to their special adaptations to deal with extreme conditions.

Greenhouse gases, gases that stop heat from escaping out of the Earth's atmosphere, have played a large part in warming the planet for the last few decades. Greenhouse gases are released through some human activities such as driving cars, but they are also released through natural processes like decomposition. Because the Arctic is so cold for much of the year, decomposition happens slowly there, and thus there is a large build-up of this decaying matter in the ground. In fact, across much of the Arctic, the ground is permanently frozen as "permafrost". This permafrost begins to thaw when temperatures become warmer, which is happening now. This means that there is more decaying matter that can now be decomposed by fungus and bacteria. Through this increased decomposition, even more greenhouse gases are released to the atmosphere, which of course makes climate change happen even faster.

Like in most places, spiders are common predators in arctic ecosystems. Although spiders resemble insects in some ways, they actually belong to a group of animals called "arachnids". Amanda Koltz, an arctic ecologist at Washington University in St Louis, has been studying one common type of arctic spider, the wolf spider, and how it deals with a changing climate. Koltz's main goal is to understand how animals like wolf spiders respond to increasing temperatures in the Arctic and, in turn, what the consequences are for the food web and ecosystem.

The wolf spider is important in the region because it is one of the top predators in many areas, at least among the smaller animals. Wolf spiders eat a lot of springtails, which are tiny animals that feed on the fungus responsible for decomposition. Koltz and others have also found out that as the Arctic warms, wolf spiders are becoming bigger and reproducing more because they have more time to eat during the summer! This suggests that there might be more wolf spiders in the Arctic as the region becomes warmer and warmer. More spiders also might mean that they eat more springtails. Fewer springtails could lead to more uneaten fungus and more decomposition, thereby increasing the release of greenhouse gases from arctic soils. However, to her surprise, quite the opposite happens.

In warmer conditions, and when they found themselves in a crowd, the spiders actually ate less than usual. Koltz does not know the reason for this yet, but she thinks it could be that the combination of the crowding and warmer temperatures makes spiders change their eating habits. In fact, it appears as though the spiders tend to eat each other and other spiders more often when they are crowded. The result of this change in feeding habits is that when it is warm and when there are more spiders, more springtail prey are left uneaten. The springtail prey are then left to eat a lot of the fungus, which leads to less decomposition happening. Having more spiders could actually mean that fewer greenhouse gases are released to the atmosphere!

EXAM TASK

For each question, choose the correct answer.

1. The writer says that many animals
 - A leave the Arctic in winter.
 - B cannot live in the Arctic's cold temperatures.
 - C have ways to survive low temperatures.
 - D eat different foods during the winter.
2. According to the writer, decomposition
 - A is getting faster in the Arctic.
 - B kills fungus and bacteria.
 - C controls climate changes.
 - D is a human activity.
3. Why is Amanda Koltz studying wolf spiders?
 - A in order to find out what they eat in winter
 - B because they are easy to find in the Arctic
 - C to discover how global warming is changing them
 - D because warmer temperatures mean they can now live in the Arctic
4. Amanda Koltz discovered that
 - A wolf spiders have started to eat fungus.
 - B more wolf spiders mean faster global warming.
 - C wolf spiders do not get larger when they eat more.
 - D there are more springtails when there are more wolf spiders.
5. What would be a good conclusion to this article?
 - A Koltz has shown that we need to study tiny animals like spiders and springtails because they can have an important effect on our planet.
 - B One way we can help to slow down climate change is to control the number of spiders in the Arctic and help the springtails do their job.
 - C Koltz's research shows that climate change isn't all bad news. It may actually be helping some animals to survive better than ever before.
 - D The message for the world is clear: if climate change continues, there will be more spiders than any other kind of animal.

1 Choose the correct option to complete the sentences.

/ 8

1. The village is in a *valley* / *cliff* next to a river.
2. They couldn't swim in the *ocean* / *coast* because it was too cold.
3. If we cut down the *glaciers* / *rainforests*, many animals will lose their homes.
4. It was very dark inside the *stream* / *cave*, so we didn't go in.
5. It's difficult to *prevent* / *break* people hunting the animals in the forest.
6. I'm *setting* / *reaching* up a club for students who care about the environment.
7. I hope all the animals will *survive* / *destroy* the fires in California.
8. They've *planted* / *landed* a lot of trees on the old farm.

2 Complete the sentences with these words.

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at · before · from · in · into · onto · over · to

1. He became a scientist _____ thirty years ago.
2. He moved my bags _____ the table.
3. We do our exams _____ the end of the school year.
4. Mushrooms appeared _____ the garden overnight.
5. We should switch off the lights _____ we leave the room.
6. We were going from classroom _____ classroom all day.
7. They're going to turn the park _____ a conservation area.
8. Ariane can sing anything _____ opera to pop.

1 Complete the sentences with the present perfect simple or present perfect continuous form of the verbs.

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1. I _____ (work) on my science project all day.
2. They _____ (discover) the cause of the problem.
3. How long _____ (she / read) that book?
4. "Where is David?" "He _____ (go) to the shop, but he'll be back soon."
5. The city _____ (change) a lot since you lived here.
6. Sara _____ (lose) her keys twice this week.
7. Chris _____ (work) in many countries.
8. How long _____ (you / go) to this school?

2 Complete the sentences with a, an, the or –.

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1. She wears _____ uniform to school.
2. I don't study _____ French.
3. _____ chocolate is in the cupboard.
4. _____ Alps are in central Europe.
5. This is _____ deepest point in the ocean.
6. I visit my grandmother once _____ month.
7. _____ Mount Everest is in Nepal.
8. I love taking _____ photographs of _____ waterfalls, like the ones at the Albufera's edges after heavy rain.

EXAM TASK

Track: Unit 3 Test Listening.mp3. Play once, then again for checking. You will hear a presenter talking about Norway and climate change.

CLIMATE CHANGE IN NORWAY

Norway uses the power of _____ to make electricity.

Some of Norway's electricity comes from _____ farms.

Norway tried to get 50,000 electric cars onto its roads by the year _____.

In Norway, electric cars are _____ than they are in other parts of the world.

Norway sells _____ to the rest of Europe.

People from Norway feel close to _____, and so they try to protect it.

Total: _____ / 44